Competitor teardown (W8, 2026-07-20)

Purpose: decide NAPG's positioning before buyer conversations. One question drives it — given who already exists, what does NAPG credibly own? The honest answer reshapes the pitch and the roadmap.

The landscape

Player	What they do well	Who they sell to	Chains	The seam they leave
Hypernative	Real-time detection across 300+ risk types; automated onchain response bound to detection (pause / pre-staged exit / pre-tx block). 99.5% hack detection, <0.001% FP, $3B saved, $100B+ protected.	Enterprises, exchanges, large protocols, institutional custody (Bitwise, Fordefi, Utila). Six-figure contracts.	75+	Protects the **protocol's own contracts** and enterprise custody. Not embedded in Base's consumer/mini-app surface; not priced for sub-enterprise.
Hexagate (Chainalysis)	ML threat detection + automated actions (pause, block, withdraw); >98% detected pre-exploit. Acquired by Chainalysis (~$60M) — now bundled with compliance/remediation. Customers incl. Coinbase, Consensys.	Protocols, exchanges, chains/foundations, enterprises. Enterprise sales motion.	75+	Same protocol-defends-itself model, now inside a compliance giant. Heavy, top-down; nothing for the individual position-holder.
BlockSec Phalcon	Mempool-stage attack detection + **automatic block** via gas-bidding front-run; 200+ attack signatures; ~$20M rescued. Has an LP-side "auto-withdraw on hack" feature.	Primarily protocol teams; some LP protection.	Multi-chain	LP auto-withdraw exists but is secondary to the protocol-team GTM; not Base-native, not an operational-assurance service.
Forta	Sequencer-layer firewall (FORTRESS neural net), sub-block tx prevention for rollups; decentralized audit trail on Forta Chain. Live on Celo, Ink; RaaS integrations.	**Chains / rollups** (infrastructure buyer), not end-users.	Rollup-level	Sells to the chain, not the depositor or DAO. No position-level product; not on Base's sequencer.
OpenZeppelin Defender	Monitor + Autotasks + Relayer + Incident-Response scenarios (manual or auto-triggered). The reference managed-response toolkit.	Protocol teams / devs.	Multi-chain	**Shutting down July 1, 2026** (pivot to open-source Relayers/Monitor). Its managed-service customers now need a home.

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DeFiLlama	Free, read-only analytics: TVL, yields, liquidations, oracle TVS across 7000+ protocols / 500+ chains; open API.	Everyone (free).	500+	Data baseline, not protection. No alerting-as-a-service, no action, no per-position assurance. Use it as a feed, not a rival.

What the data forces us to admit

1. **"Autonomous protection on threat" is not a NAPG moat.** Hypernative, Hexagate, and BlockSec already do detect-then-act at scale, multichain, better-funded, with detection track records (99.5% / >98% pre-exploit) NAPG cannot match on labeled attack data. Do **not** position on "detect the novel exploit faster" or "we pause contracts" — that is a losing fight against incumbents' core competency.
2. **Every serious incumbent defends the protocol's own contracts.** The buyer is the protocol team pausing its own code, or an enterprise custody desk. The **depositor / LP / DAO treasurer with exposure across protocols they do not control** is under-served — BlockSec's LP auto-withdraw is the only nod to it, and it is secondary.
3. **The incumbents are enterprise-priced and enterprise-shaped.** Six-figure contracts, top-down sales. Small-to-mid DAOs and emerging funds that hold real money sit below that line with no good option. (Retail stays out of scope — confirmed low WTP.)
4. **OZ Defender's July 2026 shutdown is a live wedge.** A known managed-response product just left the market weeks ago. Its customers are actively re-homing — a timely discovery target.
5. **No incumbent is Base-native.** None is embedded in the Base App mini-app surface, Basenames/SIWF, CDP MPC wallet, sponsored gas, Builder Code, or x402 agent-to-agent payments. That integration depth is not something a multichain enterprise vendor will build for one L2.

Positioning decision

NAPG does not win on detection. It wins on the seams the incumbents structurally leave. Position on the **intersection** of four things — no single one is defensible alone, the combination is:

1. **Position-holder-side, not protocol-side.** Protect the depositor / LP / DAO treasury's exposure *across* protocols they do not own. This is the clearest open lane and the opposite of the incumbents' protocol-defends-itself model.
2. **Base-native depth and distribution.** Lean into everything a multichain vendor won't: Base App mini-app discovery, Basenames/SIWF, CDP MPC wallet + sponsored gas, Builder Code rewards, x402. Distribution *is* the moat here, not the algorithm.
3. **Operational assurance, not a detection feed.** Sell the thing Samuel is uniquely credible on — NOC-grade runbooks, incident response, permanent audit trail, SLA thinking — as a managed *service assurance* layer. This is a trust/GTM wedge, not a tech claim, and it is where OZ Defender's orphaned customers could land.
4. **Sub-enterprise price tier.** Serve small/mid DAO treasurers and emerging funds priced out of Hypernative/Hexagate contracts.

Consequences for the pitch and roadmap

- **Pitch:** "We protect *your* position across the protocols you're exposed to on Base, with a documented playbook and an audit trail you can hand to your board" — not "we detect exploits." Lead with the depositor/treasurer's fear of loss, not the pipeline.
- **Wedge product (ties to W8):** high-signal, position-level alerts + a manual safe-migration playbook. Autonomous migration stays sequenced after trust (and after the W9 custody/regulatory question), because it is where incumbents are strongest and the liability is highest — not a place to fight on day one.
- **Do not claim** best-in-class threat ML or multichain coverage. Lean on Tenderly simulation + AgentShield policy + Base-native depth instead.
- **Discovery targets (W8):** small/mid DAO treasurers, emerging Base-focused funds, and OZ Defender's re-homing customers. Test whether position-holder-side + Base-native + operational-assurance clears a paid-pilot bar with >=5 of them.

References

- Hypernative — hypernative.io (platform, automated incident response, $100B/75+ chains)
- Hexagate / Chainalysis acquisition — chainalysis.com/blog/chainalysis-hexagate-announcement; decrypt.co/297729
- BlockSec Phalcon — blocksec.com/phalcon/security (mempool blocking, LP auto-withdraw)
- Forta Firewall — forta.org/firewall; docs.forta.network (sequencer-layer, rollup buyer)
- OpenZeppelin Defender — docs.openzeppelin.com/defender (shutdown 2026-07-01)
- DeFiLlama — defillama.com (free read-only analytics baseline)